BUSINESS PLAN · VERSION 3 · REWRITTEN

Algorithmic futures trading plan

Automated NQ / ES strategies traded through Apex prop-firm accounts, funding a personal account later. This version is rewritten from scratch with the plan agreed on October 30 and an honest look at the first three weeks live.

Date	Previous	Markets	Platform
October 30, 2026	**v2 Oct 24 · v1 Oct 16**	**MNQ · MES · MCL**	**MultiCharts · Rithmic · VPS**

All performance figures are backtests (2018–2026) and simulations on real market history, after costs. They are not guarantees. The plan assumes live results reach about 75% of the backtest; the first live weeks are below that, on too few trades to judge yet (section 2).

1 · AT A GLANCE

The short version

Use Apex evaluations as a cheap way to get funded capital for a set of tested, automated strategies; turn payouts into more accounts, and later into a personal account with no payout cap.

LIVE ACCOUNTS	LIVE TRADES	FUNDED BY DEC 31	2027 FROM APEX
1 of 3	**23 · −$6.2k**	**~3–6**	**~$100k**
#1 (50K) and #3 (150K) failed; #2 (50K) live, $1,064 above its floor	Gross, all accounts since 10/12. Too few trades to judge the edge	Typical, 150Ks bought from job pay (75% edge / full backtest)	Typical at 75% of the edge; ~$170k if the job continues*

The honest picture

The strategies are well tested on 2018–2026 data, but nothing is proven live yet. Two of three evaluations failed, both on one ordinary full stop at a thin cushion, which happens in about half of all evaluations even in the backtest. The bigger risk in the plan is timing: in 14–28% of simulated histories, a bad November–December fails every evaluation and nothing is funded by year end.

What we decided on October 30

Accounts

- No more new 50Ks. #2 runs to its end.
- Every new account is a **150K No-Activation** ($249, no activation fee).
- Replace #3 with #4 on Sunday Nov 1 (catches the Sunday-evening Bridge trade).
- From Nov 13: all job pay goes to 150Ks, **one purchase a day**, never several the same day.

Trading rules

- Full size always: skipping or shrinking trades on a thin cushion tested worse.
- Stop buying if the drift alarm fires (live clearly below backtest).
- Mid-December gate: 40–70 live trades at ≥75% of backtest before scaling further.
- Personal account opens once Apex pays for its own replacements (~March with the job).

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2 · WHERE WE STAND

Live results, honestly

Live since October 12 on a QuantVPS in Chicago (MultiCharts + Rithmic, data from dxFeed). Three evaluations so far.

ACCOUNT	TYPE	STARTED	STATUS	WHAT HAPPENED
#1 APEX-681524-01	50K	Oct 12	Failed 10/26	One Vault Break stop with ~$400 of room left
#2 APEX-681524-02	50K	Oct 20	Live · thin	~$49,828, $1,064 above the floor (less than one full stop); model odds to pass from here ~46%
#3 APEX-681524-03	150K No-Activation	Oct 26	Failed 10/30	Overnight Bias short (normal −115 pt loss) touched the floor intraday; Apex liquidated it

VAULT BREAK, PER TRADE

−11 pts

9 live signals vs +5 pts in the backtest. One standard error is ~17 pts: not yet meaningful

DRIFT ALARM

Not triggered

CUSUM 1.8 vs alarm at 25 (Vault Break). The alarm is built to catch a real decay early

STOP SLIPPAGE

1.8 ticks

Vault Break stops fill ~1.8 ticks worse vs 1 assumed (9 fills); targets fill 1.5 ticks better

What went wrong, and what it cost

DATE	PROBLEM	COST	FIXED BY
10/16–10/20	Orders rejected: wrong symbol mapping (@MNQ instead of MNQZ6)	Missed trades	Symbol mapping + pre-flight checklist
10/26	#3's copied charts kept #2's account: 150K-size orders hit #2	#2 briefly held 28 MNQ	Account check on every strategy after copying
10/27	Overnight Bias failed to compile while the chart looked normal; a +135 pt trade was missed	**~$1.1k on #2, ~$3.2k on #3**	Strategy heartbeat + missed-trade alarm
10/30	Apex flattened #3 without telling MultiCharts; ~100 exit orders rejected in a second	None (account already failed)	Rejected-orders limit 10; reset rule documented

The expensive one was operational, not the strategy

The missed 10/27 trade would have put ~$3,240 into #3. With that cushion, today's loss would very likely not have failed it. The monitoring built since then (below) is there to stop that class of mistake.

Live guard now in place

Phone alarms every 5 minutes in trading hours (MultiCharts down, no data, frozen chart, auto-trading off, strategy not running, position mismatch, rejected orders) · 08:21 pre-market check · trades pushed every 30 min · journal and live dashboard at 16:40 · Friday review with a Codex cross-check.

What each account trades

Every strategy is automated in MultiCharts, flat by 15:59 CT for Apex. Tiers come from the tier list (S best, then A, B). Costs: $7.25 per NQ plus 1 tick per market or stop fill. 2 strategies are your designs, 7 come from our own forced-flow research (the plan's low-correlation core), the rest from code you found.

STRATEGY	IDEA	TIER	ORIGIN	USED IN
Vault Break	Breakout above the midnight open + 30% ATR and VWAP; fixed target and stop	A	Your design	Evaluation · funded
Overnight Bias (ADX30 / ML)	08:30 open's place in the overnight range sets the side; opening-range break	A / S	Your design	Evaluation · funded
Expiration Open Short	Short the open on monthly options expiration (dealer hedges unwind)	A	Our research	Evaluation · funded
Bridge Monday Long	Sunday evening to Monday close in an up-trend	A	Outside (The Bridge)	Evaluation · funded
Late-Day Flow	Follow big moves at 14:00 CT (leveraged-ETF rebalancing)	A	Our research	Funded
Monday Long	Long Mondays 08:30–15:00 (weekend inflows)	A	Our research	150K funded · personal
NFP Fade	Fade the first payroll-report reaction	B	Our research	Funded
ES MOC Follow	Follow the pre-close move into the closing auction	B	Our research	Funded
CL Sunday gap fade	Fade crude oil's Sunday up-gap	A	Our research	Funded
Overnight Tick / VIX	Overnight long after a down day, order-flow × VIX filter	A	Outside	Funded
Swing Target v3	Break of the prior 2-day level, small target, break-even	B	Outside	Funded
T_ONESIDE fade	Night-volume switch fade	B	Outside	50K funded
Relative Strength	NQ's 09:00 move beyond its ES beta	B	Outside	150K funded · personal
Personal only	Twin Continuation (A), Dual Thrust v4 (A), PAPERTREND v2 (B); forward log first: FC 2B (A), Kusho v9, S47 v2, S30 IBS (B)			

Sizes by plan

PLAN	WHAT RUNS	BACKTEST RESULT
Evaluation (50K)	Vault Break 8 MNQ · Overnight Bias $1,100 risk · Expiration Short $500 · Bridge 2 MNQ	Pass 50%
Evaluation (150K)	The same × 2.5 (VB 20, ONB $2,750, EOS $1,250, Bridge 5)	Pass ~40%
50K funded	11 pieces: VB 1/1 + Swing Target 1, ONB ML $400, EOS, Late-Day Flow 2, NFP, ES MOC, CL fade, Bridge 1, Overnight Tick 1, T_ONESIDE 1	~$10.2k yr 1 · $12.3k / 2 yrs
150K funded	The 50K plan × 1.5 + Relative Strength 1 + Overnight Tick 2 + Swing Target 2 (+ Monday Long)	~$18.1k yr 1 · $20.3k / 2 yrs
Personal	19 pieces at 1 micro each	~$41.5k / yr, needs ~$36k

4 · EVIDENCE STANDARD

How a strategy earns its place

Most ideas fail. The process is built to reject lucky backtests before they reach an account.

IDEAS TESTED	BAR FOR A NEW ONE	THIS WEEK	HOLDOUT
348	**t ≥ 3.63**	**0 of ~20**	**2023–26**
Ranked S–F in the tier list; every test counts	Rises with each test (multiple-testing correction)	Papers, scouted papers, CHoCH, Prior VWAP Trap: none added	Kept unopened until a rule passes on 2018–22

The pipeline

STEP	WHAT HAPPENS
1 · Write the rule first	Rules and pass/fail gates are written down before results (pre-registration); no tuning after a failure
2 · Backtest honestly	1-minute data 2018–2026, full costs, longs and shorts separately, by year, placebo controls
3 · Independent check	A separate checker rebuilds the rule from its written spec; MultiCharts must reproduce the trades
4 · Add or replace	Tested on the account simulators as an addition and as a replacement; kept only if it helps the plan
5 · Live	Apex incubation, compared trade by trade with the backtest (drift alarm), then the personal account

Why live will be lower than the backtest

The plan's strategies were chosen on the same 2018–26 data they're scored on, and published market effects lose about a quarter of their returns out of sample (more after publication). The plan is sized to work at 75% of the backtest; every projection below shows both.

Research engine

Sources

- Your uploads (code, PDFs, papers)
- Paper scout: searches arXiv / NBER / SSRN, on demand ("scout") and Mon/Wed/Fri
- Codex: a second AI builder with its own tests, cross-checked weekly

Records

- Tier list (every idea ranked)
- Execution references E01–E29 (fills, slippage, market behaviour)
- Pitfall log and lessons (mistakes not to repeat)

5 · FUNDING MODEL

Apex: why 150K accounts

An evaluation is a paid test: reach the profit target without touching the trailing floor. Passing gives a funded account that pays out in capped steps, then closes.

	50K EVALUATION	150K NO-ACTIVATION
Price	~$59 + $130 activation on a pass	$249, no activation
Target / trailing floor	+$3,000 / $2,000	+$9,000 / $4,000
Pass rate (backtest)	~50%	~40%
Funded payouts, year 1 / 2 years	~$10.2k / $12.3k	~$18.1k / $20.3k
Funded account blown	~5%	~1%
Cost per funded account	~$250	~$600

Apex caps you at about **20 accounts**, so account slots run out before money does. Each 150K slot earns ~65% more and rarely blows once funded, which is why every new account is a 150K.

Thin cushions: tested twice, keep full size

RULE WHEN THE CUSHION IS THIN	50K: LOSSES PER PASS	150K: LOSSES PER PASS
Trade everything at full size (now)	**1.00**	**1.40**
Overnight Bias off below one stop	1.14	1.67
Overnight Bias risk ≤ 50% of the cushion	1.08	1.74
Overnight Bias + Vault Break off	1.76	2.89
Vault Break cut to 4 (tested 10/26)	0.95–1.02 (no gain)	—

Losses = failed + unfinished evaluations (an unfinished one costs a new fee). Skipping trades lowers failures but the account stalls and runs out of days.

Read a failed evaluation correctly

About half of all evaluations fail even in the backtest. Two failures out of three happens about 40% of the time at these rates. Judge the strategies on live trades vs backtest, not on accounts lost.

6 · THE PLAN

November–December, and 2027

Starting budget: zero. A job (Nov 10 – Dec 24, $25 × 8 h, paid weekly) funds evaluations; payouts take over from early 2027.

Buying plan

WHEN	PAY (AFTER TAX, EST.)	BUY
Sun Nov 1	savings	#4 (150K): 4 charts, new account number in every strategy
Fridays Nov 13, 20, 27, Dec 4, 11, 18	~$850 (5 days) – $1,020 (6 days)	3–4 × 150K per week, **one a day**
~Dec 24 (last pay)	~$500–700	2 × 150K, starting in January
From January	payouts (+ job if kept*)	Refill slots up to ~20

Why one a day: all accounts trade the same signals, so evaluations started on the same day pass or fail together. Spreading buys lowers the chance that nothing passes.

Projections

Budget simulation: every paycheck and every payout buys 150K evaluations (up to 20 open), tested on every start day 2018–23 in real day order.

SCENARIO	EVALUATIONS BY DEC 31	FUNDED DEC 31 BAD · TYPICAL · GOOD	NOTHING FUNDED BY DEC 31	FIRST PAYOUT	2027 PAYOUTS BAD · TYPICAL · GOOD
Job ends · full edge	23–28	0 · 6–8 · 14–17	13–14%	late Feb	$0 · $246–264k · $405k
Job kept* · full edge	23–28	0 · 6–8 · 14–17	13–14%	early Mar	$8k · $307–329k · $414k
Job ends · 75% edge	23–28	0 · 3–4 · 12–14	27–28%	late Mar	**$0 · $96–121k · $289k**
Job kept* · 75% edge	23–28	0 · 3–4 · 12–14	27–28%	late Mar	**$0 · $171–182k · $320k**

Ranges cover 5 vs 6 workdays a week. Funded payouts are modelled with the October plan, ~15% below the current 150K plan, so payouts lean low. #2 (50K) is not included: a bonus if it passes.

PLAN ON (75% EDGE)

~$100k

2027 from Apex if the job ends Dec 24

WITH THE JOB*

~$170k

From Apex; ~$215k all-in with ~$44k of pay after tax

BAD CASE

$0

If nothing passes by year end and the money is gone

Why a slow start, then a lot

A funded 150K needs +$6,600 and five $350+ days before its first payout: that takes ~2½–3½ months. After that, payouts arrive every few weeks until the account's ~$20.5k is paid. So January–February bring little or no trading income; March–December bring most of 2027.

* Assumes the job ($25/h, 8 h, 5–6 days a week, ~$850–1,020 a week after tax) continues through 2027; pay goes to evaluations until Apex reaches ~20 accounts (~February), then to the personal account. Backtest-based; the live edge is not yet confirmed.

7 · PERSONAL ACCOUNT

Apex first, personal second

$249 in an evaluation that passes earns ~$14–20k; $249 in a personal account earns ~$200 a year. So money goes to Apex until it is at its account cap and pays for its own replacements. The personal account matters most from 2028: it has no payout cap.

With the job in 2027*

- **~March:** start setting aside the paycheck + ~25% of payouts
- **~April–May:** open with starter set A (~$11.5k)
- **~Summer:** core 16 pieces (~$26k)
- 2027 contribution ~$5–10k

Job ends Dec 24

- **~June:** set aside ~25–50% of payouts
- **~July–August:** open with set A
- **~Autumn:** core 16 pieces
- 2027 contribution ~$2–5k

Conditions: the mid-December gate passed, and Apex keeps funding its own slots. If payouts dip, Apex replacements get the money first.

The capital ladder (1 micro = 1 MNQ / MES / MCL per piece)

ACCOUNT	SET	$ A YEAR (TYPICAL)	BAD YEAR
~$11.5k	A: Twin, Overnight Bias ML, Bridge, CL fade, NFP	$8.1k	$3.0k
~$13.6k	C: A + Expiration Short + Vault Break	$10.4k	$4.4k
~$20.4k	D: C + Relative Strength + ES MOC	$14.5k	$6.3k
~$26.2k	**Core: 16 pieces**	$30.5k	$17.0k
~$33.6k	Core + S30	$36.4k	$20.2k
~$54k	Core × 2 + S30	$66.8k	$38.2k
~$104k	**Core × 4 + S30 (best mix)**	$127.8k	$72.8k
~$261k	1 mini per piece	$322.4k	$185.5k

Sized so a 1-in-20 bad year's drawdown is about 20% of the account. Step up only when the account reaches the row; step down after a 20% drawdown. Live is expected at ≥75% of these.

8 · RISKS

What could go wrong

RISK	HOW LIKELY / HOW BIG	WHAT WE DO
Nothing funded by Dec 31	14–28% of histories; then 2027 can pay $0 without the job	One buy a day; keep the job into 2027 if possible; review if nothing is funded by mid-January
Live edge below backtest	Expected (~75%); first 3 weeks are below, on few trades	Drift alarm per strategy; mid-December gate; stop buying on an alarm
All accounts are one bet	Same signals everywhere: a bad month hits every account	Stagger starts; budget for several failures in a row
Evaluation failures	~50–60% of evaluations fail, even in the backtest	Treated as the cost of a pass: ~$600 per funded 150K
Operational mistakes	Already cost one ~$3.2k trade (10/27)	Watchdog, heartbeat, pre-market check, checklists for every new account
Overfitting	Strategies picked on the data they're scored on	Pre-registration, holdouts, multiple-testing bar, independent checker, forward log
Apex rules or prices change	Payout caps, consistency rule, account limits can change	Re-check the rules each month; personal account as the long-term home
Execution costs	Stops fill ~0.8 tick worse than assumed (small sample)	Re-test with 2-tick stops at ~30 fills
Personal finances	All job pay goes into evaluations	Spend only money you can lose; cover living costs first; taxes not included here

What would make us stop

A drift alarm on a core strategy, live results clearly below 75% of the backtest at the mid-December gate, or nothing funded by mid-January. Any one of these pauses new purchases until the cause is understood.

9 · TIMELINE

Next steps and decision gates

SUN NOV 1
Buy #4 (150K). Set up its 4 charts: account number in every strategy, rejected-orders limit 10, initial position Flat.

NOV 13 – DEC 24
3–4 × 150K a week from pay, one a day. Each new account added to the watchdog and dashboard.

NOV 20
Options expiration: Expiration Open Short trades.

NOV 26–27
Thanksgiving (closed) and half day: strategies use early-close times.

DEC 10
MNQ roll: symbol mapping MNQZ6 → MNQH7 after the close.

MID-DECEMBER · GATE
~40–70 live trades at ≥75% of the backtest and no drift alarm → keep scaling. Otherwise stop buying and find the cause.

DEC 31
Expect ~3–8 funded 150Ks (typical), more in January.

MID-JANUARY · CHECK
If nothing is funded: pause and review before spending more.

LATE FEB – MARCH 2027
First payouts. Payouts refill slots up to ~20.

~MARCH – MAY 2027
Personal account: set money aside, open with starter set A (~$11.5k).

Sources in the repository: TIER_LIST.md, personal_strategies/PORTFOLIO.md, funded_strategies/FUNDED_PLAN.md, analysis/ramp_budget_test.py, analysis/onb_cushion_test.py, the live dashboard (Apex Live Desk) and live/trades. Version 2 (Oct 24) and version 1 (Oct 16) are kept for comparison.